As a result, Attlee turned down Nehru's request for a stand-down of British officers by arguing that all errant British officers who had participated in the fighting would be recalled immediately. Gen. Gracey was made the scapegoat by Whitehall who called him names and charged him with disloyalty to the British crown. Quite a performance indeed!

A month later, in August 1948, Nehru once again requested a stand-down. This time, the request was routed through the Chancellor of the Exchequer, Stafford Cripps and Ismay. Both Noel-Baker and Bevin argued that the Pakistan Army would disintegrate without British officers. Pakistan was not only in the frontline against Soviet expansion but also held great leverage in the Muslim world. Furthermore, the UN which was now playing a significant role in the Kashmir conflict, viewed all British officers as a great stabilising influence.[30] By this time, the Indian armed forces had less than half of the 800-odd British personnel who were working for the Pakistan armed forces. Lastly, the treasonous link between Generals Bucher and Gracey would have snapped had the stand-down been declared. Therefore, Attlee refused Nehru's request, citing a combination of desperation and disillusionment in Pakistan, defiance by British officers there, Muslim hostility and communist profit. Four months later, for a third time, Nehru raised the issue of a stand-down with Attlee, and received his third successive refusal, this time communicated via the British Defence Secretary. By now, the entire rank of British officers in the Pakistan Army was fully engaged in the war.

Meanwhile, to buy time, the British Government commissioned the Templer Report. In November 1948, this report confirmed that 440 British officers served in executive positions in Pakistan as opposed to the 230 Britons in India.[31] This imbalance was exacerbated by Gen. Bucher's relative detachment from the war as against Gen. Gracey's hands-on involvement in it. The choices before the British, now, were to stand down or ceasefire. Nehru was fed up with the state of affairs and had announced the replacement of Gen. Bucher by Gen. Cariappa, the first Indian general of the Indian Army.[32] Bucher worked hard to secure a ceasefire on 1 January 1949, a mere 15 days before he relinquished his office.